

short relaxations/prompts

It is important to practise the relaxations in pregnancy and listen to the audio. They can also be very calming in early labour. But in established labour the surges will be too close together to have time to do a relaxation in between, although it can still be helpful to have the audio playing in the background.

You can use the triggers from the scripts you have practised to help you relax quickly in advanced labour. Here are some suggestions:

A gentle, deep breath

- Just one lovely, gentle, deep breath. As you let the air flow out in the long, relaxed outbreath, your body is producing oxytocin and endorphins. Notice as you breathe in that the air is cool and as you breathe out the air is warmer. You've fucking got this.

Relax

- The word 'Relax' takes them back to the confidence, calm and comfort above the soft clouds. This image is very powerful.

Stroking

- Stroking on any part of the body that is convenient. If available the forehead and the space between the eyebrows can be especially relaxing.

Safe place

- Remind her to bring to mind her special place where she feels happy and at ease.

Drop your shoulders

- You will be amazed how much tension suddenly falls away that you didn't know was there when you allow your shoulders to drop.

Partner's voice – think back to the partner relaxation.

Soft mouth

- Look for tension in the jaw, make sure her mouth and jaw are relaxed – stroking, kissing. Floppy Face- Floppy Fanny!

Back stroking

- The back stroking.massage on the video on YouTube.

